

MEDICAL POWER OF ATTORNEY (HEALTHCARE PROXY)

Parties

Principal: _____

Healthcare Agent: _____

Alternate Healthcare Agent: _____

Grant of Healthcare Decision-Making Authority

The Principal appoints the Healthcare Agent named above to make healthcare decisions on the Principal's behalf if the Principal's attending physician determines that the Principal is unable to make or communicate those decisions personally. This authority covers healthcare decisions only and does not grant the Agent any authority over the Principal's finances, property, or other legal affairs.

Scope of Authority

The Agent's authority includes consenting to, refusing, or withdrawing medical treatment; selecting or dismissing physicians and other healthcare providers; and choosing among available healthcare facilities and care settings, consistent with the Principal's known wishes and best interests.

Additional Instructions or Limitations: _____

Authorization to Access Medical Information

The Principal authorizes healthcare providers to disclose the Principal's protected health information to the Agent (and any named alternate) to the extent necessary for the Agent to make informed healthcare decisions under this document.

Guidance on Life-Sustaining Treatment

In making decisions about life-sustaining treatment, the Agent should follow the directions in any separate living will or advance healthcare directive the Principal has signed. Where no such document addresses the situation, the Agent should act according to the Principal's known wishes or, if those are unknown, in the Principal's best interest.

Reference to Separate Living Will/Advance Directive (if any): _____

Effective Date

This medical power of attorney becomes effective only upon a determination, consistent with applicable law, that the Principal is unable to make or communicate healthcare decisions, and remains effective for as long as that incapacity continues.

Revocation

The Principal may revoke this document at any time while able to do so, by written notice, by destroying it, or by executing a later medical power of attorney.

Notarization and Witnessing Requirements

Requirements for a valid medical power of attorney vary by state — many require one or more disinterested witnesses, some require notarization, and some restrict who may serve as a witness or as the Agent (for example, excluding the Principal's own healthcare providers). Confirm the requirements that apply where the Principal lives and complete them before relying on this document.

Governing Law

This document shall be governed by the laws of the State/Country of _____, without regard to its conflict-of-law principles.

Signatures

Principal Signature: _____

Name: _____

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

Agent Signature: _____

Name: _____

Date: ____ / ____ / ____